FREQUENCIES

A short film screenplay

A visual short film about late night loneliness and analog sound.

FADE IN:

INT. ATTIC BEDROOM - NIGHT (11:45 PM)

A desk lamp casts a warm oval of light across a workbench covered in wires, small tools, and an old analog shortwave radio receiver. CLARA (17) sits in a wooden chair wearing heavy studio headphones. Outside her dormer window, the quiet roofs of the suburban town stretch into pitch darkness. Clara slowly turns the weighted tuning dial on the receiver. SOUND: White noise, static crackles, whistle of atmospheric interference. She tunes past foreign language broadcasts, Morse code bursts, and automated weather telemetry. She stops at 6.075 MHz. Through thick static, a faint human voice cuts in: a night-shift ham radio operator somewhere hundreds of miles away speaking about the temperature in his shed.

INT. KITCHEN - LATER (12:30 AM)

Clara walks barefoot onto the cold linoleum floor. She opens the refrigerator, holds the door open for a moment in the pale interior light, then closes it without taking anything out. The house is completely silent.

INT. ATTIC BEDROOM - NIGHT (1:15 AM)

Clara returns to her desk. She rests her head on her folded arms next to the radio speaker, watching the orange backlight of the frequency dial glow. She turns the dial slightly. The static softens into a low, steady hum, like ocean waves recorded from a great distance. She closes her eyes, letting the sound fill the room.

She sits up, opens a small notebook, and writes down the date, time, and frequency number in neat, quiet handwriting. The page is filled with dozens of similar entries going back months. She switches off the desk lamp. The orange radio light remains, glowing softly in the dark room until dawn.

THE END

FADE OUT.